The political leadership, at its best, is able to see opportunities for progress in a difficult situation, and seize opportunities for game-changing reforms. This requires strength of character, an entrepreneurial sense of timing and a commitment to progress in the long run. Arun Jaitley, Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Capt. Satish Sharma, D.P. Dhar, George Fernandes, Jaswant Singh, J. Vengal Rao, Dr Manmohan Singh, Mohan Dharia, P. Chidambaram, Pranab Mukherjee and Yashwant Sinha were the political leaders who gave me the opportunity to experience the highs and lows in some the great 'policy yagnas' of the past forty years. For this, I am deeply grateful to them. Lessons from these experiences form the core of many sections of this book.

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—Vijay Kelkar

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